coined the term “Cold War” back in 1947, proposed such a swap in his column “Today and Tomorrow” in the *Washington Post*. On the same day Rusk attacked the proposal at a meeting with reporters. He also sent a cable to Turkey reassuring its government of the continuing American commitment to their country’s security. But the damage had already been done. Anatoly Dobrynin included Rusk’s rebuff of Lippmann in his report to Moscow, and, according to Anastas Mikoyan, Lippmann’s proposal became common knowledge in Khrushchev’s circle.[10]

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ON THE MORNING OF OCTOBER 27, THE IDEA OF A TURKISH-CUBAN swap was suddenly revived with the incoming news about Khrushchev’s new public proposal. For Kennedy it emerged as the only hope for a peaceful resolution of the crisis. The blockade only sent a signal that the Kennedy administration was serious and could prevent the delivery of new missiles but did next to nothing about the existing ones. A trade could remove the missiles that Khrushchev had managed to deliver before the blockade began.

Kennedy was prepared to treat Khrushchev’s new letter, whose content had not yet been independently confirmed, as an indication of Khrushchev’s new and thus real negotiating position. Kennedy also saw no reason to refuse the swap, or even a possibility of doing so. As he insisted on discussing Khrushchev’s new proposal even before a full summary of it had been delivered to the Cabinet Room, he told his skeptical aides: “We’re going to be in an insupportable position on this matter if this becomes his proposal. In the first place, we last year tried to get the missiles out of there because they’re not militarily useful, number one. Number two, it’s going to—to any man at the United Nations or any other rational man, it will look like a very fair trade.”[11]

Kennedy’s aides stuck to their guns, opposing the very idea of engaging in a discussion with Khrushchev over Turkey. But Kennedy’s weak position suddenly became stronger as more details about Khrushchev’s proposal were released by the media. It was becoming clear that earlier media reports